

Video memory size

Q. I have a P4 1.5 GHz, 256 MB SDRAM, 40 GB 7,200 rpm hard drive and a 64 MB SDR nVidia GeForce2 MX 400 graphics card.

While fiddling about with my BIOS recently, I came across an option wherein the AGP aperture size is set to 64. I would like to know whether this is applicable only for integrated graphics chipsets. If not, what does it mean for my system configuration. Will increasing it to 128 increase my graphics performance?

Sai Krishnan

A The AGP aperture is the portion of the PCI addressable memory range that is dedicated as graphics memory address space. It determines the amount of system RAM that can be allocated to the graphics card for storing texture details. It is recommended that the aperture size be half of your system RAM. Typically, set the aperture to 64 MB or 128 MB. As the memory on the graphics card increases, the system requirement decreases. Hence there is no need to set the aperture size to half the system RAM. The aperture size is in no way related to performance. Increasing it to the largest setting would not result in performance gains.

Can't boot

Q. I have a Pentium 4 processor, 128 MB DDR RAM and a 40 GB hard disk. When I boot up Windows XP, I get an error saying, "Unmountable boot volume" displayed on a blue screen. The error directs me to remove recently installed hardware or software first. Since I also have Windows 98 SE in another partition that works fine, how can I get rid of the error message?

Arvind Kumar

A This problem occurs when you have a corrupted boot.ini file. Boot up using the Windows XP CD. Press **[R]** when you get the Setup screen, to get to a DOS-like mode. Here, type `chkdsk /p` and press **[Enter]**. After it is done, type `fixboot`, press **[Enter]**, then **[y]** and then again press **[Enter]**. After this, type `exit` to reboot to Windows. This should solve your problem.

If it doesn't, boot into the CD again. Type `chkdsk /r` to switch to the recovery mode. When it is finished type `exit` to reboot to Windows. This should definitely help you out.

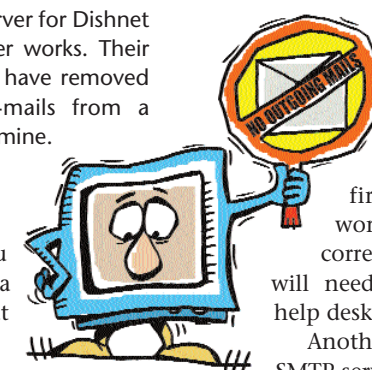
Relay not allowed

Q. The outgoing mail server for Dishnet DSL and NOW no longer works. Their help desk says that they have removed the facility to send e-mails from a domain account such as mine. What do I do now?

Paradise

A It appears that you have an e-mail id on a domain other than that provided by Dishnet, or NOW. Many Internet Service Providers such as VSNL and Sancharnet, provide SMTP solutions.

Under this service, e-mails from private domains are relayed through their SMTP server. Purchase one of those



ILLUSTRATIONS: Farzana Cooper

services depending upon your need.

If you are unable to send e-mails through your Dishnet or NOW e-mail id, then first check the password. If you are using the correct password, then you will need to contact the ISP help desk.

Another solution is to get SMTP services for your domain from the Web hosting company that is hosting your Web site. You may also host your own SMTP server on a system that is connected to the Internet 24 hours a day. IIS under Windows NT is one such alternative.

gpedit not available

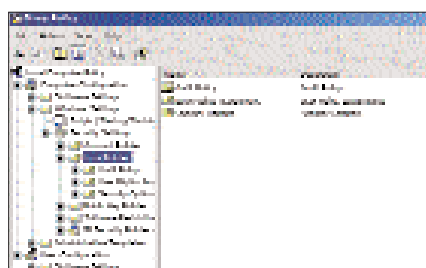
Q. I tried to bring up the group policy editor by typing the command `gpedit.msc` in the Run dialog box in Windows XP. But, the PC gave up an error message saying, "Windows cannot find 'gpedit.msc' Make sure you typed the name correctly and try again". I tried several times, but to no avail. So, I tried to locate that file by using the search utility. I found that there is no file named `gpedit.msc`. Kindly help me!

Benenet

A You probably have Windows XP Home installed on your PC, under which the `gpedit.msc` command is not available. Hence, you will need to upgrade your operating system to Windows XP Professional.

Graphics card or a processor

Q. I have a PII 300 MHz system with 128 MB RAM and a 32 MB Sis 300/305 AGP card. I have noticed that games such as *FIFA 2003*, which run very slow on my PC, run smoothly on my friend's computer—a



The group policy editor comes with Windows XP Professional

PIII 500 MHz system with only an 8 MB AGP card. I want to know what affects the graphics capability of a system—a processor faster by 200 MHz, or a graphics card with 16 MB of extra RAM? Is there any way I can improve the performance without buying new hardware?

Piyush Mishra

A Your friend's PC is a PIII, which has an optimised instruction set that handles the graphics better than your PII. The processing speed also cannot be neglected; after all, everything depends on the CPU's processing power. Hence, a surplus of 200 MHz processing power will definitely make a difference.

Sorry, there is no way you can improve your system performance without upgrading the hardware.

Crack game

Q. I was using the trial version of the *7Tools Partition Manager 2003*. Ever since the trial period expired, I get an error message about the expiry that waits for a minute at the boot up screen, every time I start the PC.

I also receive a message saying that a CD is needed when I try to play *Age of Empires*. This error occurred after installing an update for the game, downloaded from the Microsoft Web site.

Vinodh

A Upgrade to the full version of the Boot Manager. If you don't want to buy the program, un-install it and the mes-